

Tester Instructions

Last updated: 12 August 2026

Application: <https://pairedtesting-lab.vercel.app/>

Use this guide when setting up your account and completing a paired-testing assignment. Follow only the condition shown on your side, coordinate timing with your assigned partner, and never book the ride.

1. Accept your email invitation

1. Open the invitation email sent by the administrator.
2. Click the account setup link.
3. Complete the three setup sections below.

Verify your location

1. Allow the browser to access your current location.
2. Click **Verify my location**.
3. Your detected country and country code will be saved and locked to your profile.

If precise location is unavailable, the system may use your IP-detected country.

Enter your device information

Provide the device you will use for testing:

- Device model
- Operating system: iOS or Android
- OS version

Network type and ride-hailing app version are not saved in your device profile. You must provide them during every test session because they may change.

Create your password

1. Enter a password containing at least 12 characters.
2. Enter the same password under **Confirm password**.
3. Review your verified location and device information.
4. Create your account and sign in.

If you forget your password, use **Forgot password** on the sign-in page.

2. Open and review your assignment

1. Sign in to the Paired Testing Lab.
2. Open **Assigned Studies** and select the correct study.

3. Open its featured **Next assignment** or the **Assignments** tab.

4. Carefully review:

- Scheduled testing window
- Assigned ride-hailing provider
- Assigned ride category
- Pickup location and instructions
- Destination and instructions
- Your assigned testing condition
- Coordinator instructions

Your partner's condition may be hidden. Follow only the condition displayed on your side, and do not ask your partner to reveal their hidden condition.

3. Confirm readiness with your partner

Before starting, communicate with your assigned partner and confirm that both of you are ready.

Verify that:

- You are both available during the scheduled testing window.
- You are using your individually assigned provider and ride category.
- Your assigned condition is correct.
- You both entered the correct pickup and destination.
- You understand the coordinator's instructions.
- You are both ready to follow the coordinated start cue.

When the testing window opens, click **I'm ready**.

Wait until your partner has also confirmed readiness. When both testers show **Ready**, agree on the start cue and use the **Start test** control as instructed.

4. Start the controlled test

Before clicking **Start test**, be ready to collect both required evidence files:

- Full-screen quote screenshot
- Screen recording

After both testers are ready:

1. Coordinate the start cue with your partner.
2. Click **Start test**.
3. During the countdown, begin screen recording.
4. When the system tells you to request the quote, open the assigned ride option.
5. Keep your assigned ride category selected.
6. Take a full-screen screenshot showing:

- The selected ride card
- Displayed fare
- Phone status-bar time

1. **Do not book the ride.**

2. Stop and save the screen recording after capturing the required evidence.

The screenshot and screen recording must come from the same test attempt.

5. Complete the capture checklist and unlock uploads

After the test starts, the application displays the authoritative route, assigned service, capture steps, and an optional video tutorial.

Confirm all six items:

- Correct pickup and destination were entered.
- Correct provider and assigned ride tier were selected.
- Screen recording started before requesting the quote.
- Fare and device time are visible.
- Full-screen quote screenshot was captured.
- Screen recording was stopped and saved.

Select **Unlock evidence upload**. The screenshot and recording controls remain locked until every item is confirmed.

6. Upload your evidence

Upload both required files:

1. Upload the quote screenshot.
2. Upload the screen recording.

If you need guidance, click the sample screenshot to open an example inside the application.

Make sure the screenshot is clear and shows the entire phone screen. Do not crop, blur, edit, or cover important parts of the screenshot.

The screenshot must clearly display:

- Selected ride category
- Displayed fare
- Phone status-bar time

7. Wait for OCR and confirm the detected screenshot details

After uploading the screenshot, the application may display **Screenshot uploaded — waiting for OCR** or **Processing screenshot OCR**. Google Cloud Vision processes the stored screenshot, and temporary failures are retried automatically. You may upload the screen recording while OCR is processing.

When processing finishes, the screenshot review window opens. You must select three detected boxes.

Selected ride

- Choose the complete ride card that is visibly selected in the ride-hailing application.
- The selected ride must match the ride category assigned to you.

Displayed fare

- Choose the fare shown inside the selected ride card.
- Do not choose another fare displayed above or below the selected ride.

Screenshot time

- Choose the phone time displayed in the top status bar.
- Do not choose an estimated arrival time such as “7 minutes away.”

You can select a value by clicking either:

- The highlighted box directly on the screenshot; or
- Its detected value on the right side of the window.

The selected values cannot be manually typed or edited because they must come directly from the screenshot.

When screenshot processing or validation fails

If OCR remains queued or processing, keep the page open or return to the assignment later. The job status is stored. If processing fails after three attempts, record the exact error and contact the coordinator; do not repeatedly replace a valid screenshot merely to restart processing.

The system validates each selection immediately. You cannot continue when:

- The selected ride does not match your assignment.
- The selected fare is not inside the chosen ride card.
- The screenshot time is outside the valid test period.
- A required value was not detected.
- The detected choices are incorrect or unusable.

If any required value has no correct choice:

1. Close the screenshot review.
2. Repeat the controlled test with your partner as required.
3. Capture a new full-screen screenshot.
4. Capture a new screen recording from the same repeated attempt.
5. Replace both existing evidence files.

The screenshot and recording must always represent the same test attempt.

8. Wait for your partner's evidence

After your screenshot is confirmed and your recording is uploaded, the application shows that your evidence is complete. Final session details remain closed until your partner also completes their screenshot confirmation and recording.

Do not share or compare fares while waiting. You may safely leave and return to the assignment.

9. Complete the remaining session details

After the screenshot is confirmed, the detected fare and timestamp are automatically filled and locked. You cannot manually edit those two values.

Complete the fields required by the active protocol. These may include:

- Battery percentage from 0 to 100
- Current location using **Use my location**
- Network used during the session
- Current ride-hailing app version
- Optional notes

Make sure the battery, location, network, and app version describe the device and connection used for that specific test.

Not every field is required in every study. Follow the required markers shown in the application.

10. Save your draft

Click **Save draft** after completing the required information.

Saving a draft:

- Preserves your evidence and session information.
- Does not submit or lock your observation.
- Allows you to return and finish later.

If you change any value or replace evidence after saving, click **Save draft** again.

Refresh and recovery

If you refresh the page, close the browser, or return later, the application should restore:

- Current draft
- Uploaded screenshot
- Uploaded screen recording
- OCR-detected choices
- Selected screenshot boxes
- Screenshot validation result
- Confirmed fare and timestamp

- Saved or unsaved status
- Correct workflow step

The browser's file chooser may appear empty after refreshing because websites cannot restore a local file selection. Look for the stored filename, **Uploaded** badge, screenshot preview, and **Replace** button to confirm that your evidence is still stored.

If screenshot review was unfinished, use **Review detected boxes** to continue.

11. Review and submit your observation

Before submitting, verify that:

- ☐ The screenshot is uploaded and validated.
- ☐ The screen recording is uploaded.
- ☐ The selected ride matches your assignment.
- ☐ The fare and timestamp came from the screenshot.
- ☐ Battery percentage is entered.
- ☐ Current location is recorded.
- ☐ Network type is entered.
- ☐ Ride-hailing app version is entered.
- ☐ Your latest changes are saved.

Then:

1. Click **Review and submit**.
2. Review the final confirmation.
3. Click **Submit and lock**.

After submission, the observation becomes locked. You cannot edit the form or replace evidence unless an authorized user reopens it.

Wait for your partner to complete and submit their observation. Once both testers have submitted, the paired observations can proceed to matching, validation, and review.

12. Troubleshooting quick reference

Message or condition	What to do
Testing window has not opened	Review the assignment and wait for the countdown.
Waiting for your partner to become ready	Coordinate only readiness and start timing; do not discuss quote values.
Evidence uploads are locked	Complete all six capture acknowledgements and select Unlock evidence upload .
Waiting for OCR / Processing screenshot OCR	Keep the page open or return later; processing and retry state are stored.
OCR failed after three attempts	Record the exact message and contact the coordinator. Replace files only when instructed or when the attempt itself is invalid.
Waiting for your partner's evidence	Your evidence is safe; final details open after both testers complete required evidence.
Correct ride, fare, or time is not offered	Repeat the controlled attempt as directed and replace both screenshot and recording from the same attempt.